# Pablo Álvarez-Aragón

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**Contact Information**
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Department of Economics, Piazza Scaravilli 2, Bologna

**Personal Information**
Citizenship: Spanish
Born in 1997


## Research Interests

**Primary:** Development Economics
**Secondary:** Economic History, Economics of Religion, Family Economics

## Academic Appointments

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| Oct 2025 – | **University of Bologna**, Department of Economics<br>Postdoctoral Researcher<br>*Advisor*: Elisabetta de Cao |

## Education

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|---|---|
| Sep 2021 – Sep 2025 | **University of Namur (CRED)**<br>Ph.D. in Development Economics<br>*Advisor*: Catherine Guirkinger<br>*Jury*: Jean-Marie Baland (UNamur), Augustin Bergeron (Harvard), Pauline Rossi (Ecole Polytechnique-CREST) |
| Sep 2023 – Mar 2024 | **Paris School of Economics**<br>Visiting Scholar<br>*Sponsor*: Denis Cogneau |
| Mar 2025 | **Vancouver School of Economics**<br>Visiting Scholar<br>*Sponsors*: Siwan Anderson, Nathan Nunn |
| 2019 – 2021 | **UCLouvain**<br>M.Sc. in Economics, *summa cum laude* |
| 2015 – 2019 | **University of Valladolid**<br>B.A. in Economics |
| 2016 – 2019 | **University of Lille**<br>B.A. in Economics |
| 2026 – | **National University of Distance Education (UNED)**<br>B.A. in Anthropology |

## Publications

**Measuring Norms and Enumerator Effects: Survey Method Matters**
(with H. Champeaux)
*The World Bank Economic Review*, 2026

## Working Papers

**Living for the Lineage: Ancestral Beliefs and the Spiritual Foundations of Fertility in Sub-Saharan Africa**

**Religious Competition and Educational Inequality in Post-colonial D.R. Congo**
(with P. Villar and C. Guirkinger)
*Conditionally accepted, Journal of Development Economics*

**Shaking the Traditional Order: Women's Conversion to New Christian Churches in Sub-Saharan Africa**
(with J.-P. Platteau and C. Guirkinger)

**It Takes a Lineage: Kinship Structure and Fertility in Sub-Saharan Africa**
(with L. Angelini and A. Jolivet)

**Islam and the Fate of Clans in Africa**
(with J.-P. Platteau and C. Guirkinger)

## Selected Work in Progress

**Husbands in the Room: The Impact of Joint vs. Women-Only Training on Household Dynamics in Benin**
(with C. Guirkinger, A. Jolivet and A. Lulle)

**The Invisible Leash: Belief Systems and the Perpetuation of Gender Inequality**

**A Century of Education in the D.R. Congo: Colonial Origins, Patterns and Dynamics**
(with C. Guirkinger and P.Villar)

## Other Writings

Robustness and Replicability in Development Economics (in progress). PI: Jörg Ankel-Peters; co-PIs: Anna Dreber and Magnus Johannesson.

Álvarez-Aragón, P. (2026). "De las grandes a las pequeñas preguntas, y ¿viceversa? Medio siglo de economía del desarrollo a propósito de la traducción de La Gran Divergencia de Kenneth Pomeranz" *Revista Papeles de Relaciones Ecosociales y Cambio Global, Forthcoming*.

Álvarez-Aragón, P., Baland, J.-M., Guirkinger, C., Villar, P. (2025). "L'héritage des Soeurs Catholiques Missionnaires : Effets sur le Capital Humain des Femmes en République Démocratique du Congo." *Revue d'Économie du Développement*.

Álvarez-Aragón, P. (2022). "Lucas Chancel; Unsustainable Inequalities: Social Justice and the Environment." *Revista Papeles de Relaciones Ecosociales y Cambio Global*.

Álvarez-Aragón, P. (2021). "Sobre Los Premios 'Nobel' De Economía." *Revista de Economía Crítica*.

Álvarez-Aragón, P. (2021). "Slobodian, Quinn; Globalists. The End of Empire and the Birth of Neoliberalism." *Revista de Economía Crítica*.

## Seminars and Conferences

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| 2027 | Culture and Policy Workshop, Stellenbosch University |
| 2026 | III Spanish Workshop in Development Economics (Fundación Ramón Areces); Internal Seminar, University of Bologna; ASREC Annual Conference, Chapman University; CSAE Conference, Oxford University; Bristol Applied Economics Meeting; NOVAFRICA Annual Conference |
| 2025 | ASREC Conference, University of Macedonia; CRED Workshop, UNamur; Job Market Training, CERDI; II Spanish Workshop in Development Economics (Navarra Center for International Development); IRES Lunch Seminar, UCLouvain; Doctoral Workshop UCLouvain–Namur–USaint-Louis ($\times$2); Vodoun School of Economics, Ouidah; CSAE Conference, Oxford University; Workshop on Cultural Transmission and Persistence, Queen's University Belfast; International Conference in Development Economics (ICDE), Paris Nanterre University |
| 2024 | ICDE, Aix-Marseille School of Economics; University of Santiago de Compostela; AFEPOP 2024; EHESS; Casual Friday Development Seminar, Paris School of Economics; Annual Conference of the Spanish Economic Association, University of Salamanca; Atelier Simiand, Paris School of Economics; UCLouvain–Namur–USaint-Louis Doctoral Workshop ($\times$2); Institutions, Culture, and Long-Term Development Conference, CRED; CRED Workshop, UNamur; Development Economics Workshop, Universitat de Barcelona School of Economics |
| 2023 | University of Valladolid Internal Seminar; ASREC Conference, Harvard University; UCLouvain–Namur–USaint-Louis Doctoral Workshop; PARSC Conference, African School of Economics; CRED Workshop, UNamur |
| 2022 | University of Castilla-La-Mancha; CRED Workshop, UNamur; UCLouvain–Namur–USaint-Louis Doctoral Workshop |

## Teaching Experience

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| 2024 – 2025 | **Economic Tools to Solve Global Challenges** (graduate)<br>UCLouvain & U. Namur<br>Teaching Assistant to Prof. Guilhem Cassan (Namur) and Prof. Amma Panin (UCLouvain) |

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| 2022 – 2023 | **Applied Econometrics** (graduate)<br>University of Namur<br>Teaching Assistant to Prof. Wouter Gelade, National Bank of Belgium |

## Research Assistantships

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| 2020 – 2021 | Research Assistant to Marcus Biermann, Bielefeld University |
| 2018 – 2019 | Research Assistant to Óscar Carpintero, University of Valladolid |

## Fieldwork and Data Collection

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| 2021 – 2025 | Fieldwork in Benin (2025 $\times$2; 2024 $\times$2; 2023; 2021) |
| 2026 | Fieldwork in Zambia |
| 2022, 2026 | Research assistant supervision |

## Fellowships and Awards

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| 2026 – 2030 | FNRS WELCHANGE 2025 (co-PI) — Women and Religious Conversion, 223,125 € |
| 2025 – | Postdoctoral Fellowship — European Research Council (ERC 2024, COG 101170376) |
| 2025 | Scientific Stay Grant — Special Research Fund (FSR), 2,500 € |
| 2024 | Robustness and Replicability in Economics (R2E) — German Science Foundation (DFG), Priority Programme "Meta-Rep" |
| 2023 | Scientific Stay Grant (FSR-FNRS), 2,500 € |
| 2023 – 2025 | Doctoral Fellowship — Fonds National de la Recherche Scientifique (FNRS) |
| 2022 – 2023 | Doctoral Fellowship — Special Research Fund (FSR) |
| 2021 – 2022 | Doctoral Fellowship — European Research Council (H2020/ERC, StG 759294) |
| 2018 – 2019 | Collaboration Fellowship — MINECO, Spanish Government |
| 2017 – 2018 | Erasmus+ Mobility Scholarship — European Union |

## Skills and Languages

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| Software | Stata, SurveyCTO, KoboToolBox, QGIS, LaTeX, MS Office |
| Languages | Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (advanced) |

## Professional Activities and Service

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| Refereeing | Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Economic Growth; Review of Development Economics; BMJ Public Health; Health Economics |
| 2023 | Organizer, Doctoral Workshop in Economics — UNamur, UCLouvain & USaint-Louis |

## References

**Catherine Guirkinger**
Full Professor of Economics
University of Namur
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**Jean-Philippe Platteau**
Emeritus Professor of Economics
University of Namur
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**Jean-Marie Baland**
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